DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 12

Product designer

Profession 12 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A product designer owns the design of a product from problem to launch, working with product managers and engineers on research, interaction design and the interface.

What professionals do every day

Frames problems with the team, researches users, prototypes solutions, tests them, designs the interface and measures outcomes after launch.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Teams need someone who connects user needs, business goals and technical limits. A product designer makes that connection visible.

- Features built without evidence of user need.
- Interfaces that do not match the business goal.
- Slow decisions because options are not tested.

Skills you need

- Problem framing and research.
- Interaction design and prototyping.
- Testing and metrics (see Module A of the Marketing department for metrics).
- Collaboration with engineers.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Figma	Prototypes and design files	Free starter	Paid plans	www.figma.com
Maze	Testing with users	Free tier	Paid plans	maze.co
Amplitude	Product analytics (verify plans)	Free tier	Paid plans	amplitude.com
Miro	Workshops and maps	Free tier	Paid plans	miro.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Run one prototype test and write a findings summary.
Intermediate	Design one feature end to end with a success metric.
Advanced	Lead a design critique with a checklist.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Onboarding redesign for a learning app.
- **Intermediate:** Pricing page experiment.
- **Advanced:** Feature design for a booking product.

Client-ready portfolio project

A product design case study for a fictional app: problem, research, three solutions tested, the chosen design, a success metric and the post-launch plan.

Worked example

Worked example. Users abandon onboarding at step three. Two prototypes are tested; the shorter version finishes faster and is chosen, with completion rate as the success metric.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Test two prototypes and choose

Business problem: A team cannot decide between two onboarding designs.

Steps

1. Build two low-fidelity prototypes.
2. Test each with five users on the same tasks.
3. Compare completion and time.
4. Choose one and define a success metric.

Expected output: A comparison table and the decision with reasons.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

A fair test uses the same tasks and the same users type. Completion and time are compared directly. The decision is written with the metric that will show whether it worked.

Common mistakes

- Testing with the design team.
- Choosing by preference rather than evidence.
- No success metric.
- Ignoring the engineering cost of a design.

Freelancing opportunities

- Product design for start-ups.
- Fractional design leadership for product teams.
- Briefs for 'product design', 'UX case study', 'prototype testing'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Nielsen Norman Group articles

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.